

OCBC Bank

First take: NIM decline to weigh on stock

Neutral

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (31 Jul 25): S\$16.87

Price Target (Jun-26): S\$18.00

Our First Take: OCBC declared 2Q25 profits of S\$1,816mn, down 7% y/y, 4% q/q and 6% below JPMe. NIM declined 12bps q/q to 1.92% on the back of lower SORA and Hibor. The offsets came from cost control and lower provisions of 14bps (vs. 2bps increase in the NPL ratio), which led to NPL coverage drawdown of ~750bps q/q to 141%. Loan growth of 7% y/y and deposits of 10% y/y were broadly in-line. Non-II missed on insurance, with fee delivering a beat, led by WM. DPS for 1H of 41c was down 7% y/y, with interim payout flat y/y at 50%. We forecast 62% payout for the full year. Guidance of 1.90-1.95% NIM for the full year (vs. 1H25 of 1.98%) suggests quarterly NIM, at best, flat q/q for the next two quarters. This should drive negative revisions for OCBC and the sector. AQ was a touch weaker, with NPL pick-up in general commerce, financial institutions and building and construction in the industry cut (1H25). A DPS cut could be possible, especially if NIM comes in at the lower end of guidance or AQ issues emerge. These core trends are weaker vs. those implied by the YTD strength in the sector. Hence we expect a degree of weakness for OCBC, as well as UOB and DBS. We continue to maintain N on all three stocks.



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Key Positives

Fee income held up better, with WM up 4% q/q from a seasonally strong 1Q. IB fees were strong in 2Q. Costs were well-managed with only 1% y/y growth.

Key Negatives/Question Marks

NIM declined 12bps q/q to 1.92%, more than our expectations, largely driven by lower loan yields in HK and SG. Insurance was weaker-than-expected. NPAs moved up 3% q/q, with 1H break-up indicating increases in Greater China and and RoW.

Likely Changes to Consensus

We see risk of negative revisions post results.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect a negative stock price reaction.

Conference Call Details

OCBC is holding a briefing at 9:30am SGT today. Please let us know if you'd like to register.

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Table 1: OCBC: 2Q25 Earnings Review

P&L (\$mn)	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25A	2Q25E	YoY	QoQ	JPMe
Net Interest Income	2,430	2,433	2,455	2,345	2,283	2,324	-6%	-3%	-2%
Non-Interest Income	1,199	1,369	961	1,310	1,264	1,341	5%	-4%	-6%
Net Fee Income	466	508	517	546	580	557	24%	6%	4%
Trading and Others	733	861	444	764	684	784	-7%	-10%	-13%
Operating Revenue	3,629	3,802	3,416	3,655	3,547	3,665	-2%	-3%	-3%
Operating Costs	(1,373)	(1,463)	(1,560)	(1,415)	(1,389)	(1,430)	1%	-2%	-3%
PPOP	2,256	2,339	1,856	2,240	2,158	2,235	-4%	-4%	-3%
Provisions	(144)	(169)	(208)	(212)	(114)	(163)	-21%	-46%	-30%
Associates	243	251	245	274	263	279	8%	-4%	-6%
Amortization, tax, NCI	(411)	(447)	(206)	(419)	(491)	(413)	19%	17%	19%
Net Attributable Profit	1,944	1,974	1,687	1,883	1,816	1,937	-7%	-4%	-6%
Common Equity	55,219	55,932	57,616	59,190	58,073	61,714	5%	-2%	-6%
Gross Loans	303,983	305,417	319,166	322,175	324,606	326,954	7%	1%	-1%
Net Loans	299,980	301,285	315,096	317,885	320,413	322,621	7%	1%	-1%
Deposits	369,295	369,280	390,687	402,732	406,943	406,510	10%	1%	0%
NPL	2,817	2,745	2,827	2,898	2,983	2,979	6%	3%	0%
LLR	4,003	4,132	4,070	4,290	4,193	4,333	5%	-2%	-3%
							Change in bps		
NIM	2.20%	2.18%	2.15%	2.04%	1.92%	1.96%	(28)	(12)	(4)
ROE	14.0%	14.1%	11.8%	12.7%	12.4%	12.6%	(158)	(32)	(25)
CIR	37.8%	38.5%	45.7%	38.7%	39.2%	39.0%	133	45	13
LDR	82.3%	82.7%	81.7%	80.0%	79.8%	80.4%	(255)	(23)	(66)
CASA Ratio	47.8%	48.4%	48.8%	48.9%	49.8%	49.2%	202	90	63
Credit Costs (bps)	19	22	27	26	14	20	(5)	(12)	(6)
NPL Ratio	0.93%	0.90%	0.89%	0.90%	0.92%	0.91%	(1)	2	1
Coverage Ratio	142%	151%	144%	148%	141%	145%	(154)	(747)	(490)
CET1 (Fully phased-in)	15.5%	15.6%	15.3%	15.5%	15.3%	15.9%	(23)	(20)	(62)
DPS (\$)	0.44	0.00	0.57	0.00	0.41	0.50	-7%	NM	-18%

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Neutral; Price Target: S\$18.00)*

Investment Thesis

We hold a Neutral rating on OCBC.

- The bank is targeting to deliver S\$3bn incremental revenues by 2025 (vs. 2022), supported by investments in wholesale banking and WM, among others. These are aimed at capturing flows between Asean and Greater China. The targets appear achievable if execution meets expectations, and economic conditions cooperate.
- The shift in capital management including its S\$2.5bn capital return plan over 2Y and dividend payout of ~60% have helped address some of historical concerns on capital. Further, post GE, there is scope for capital management to step up. Yet, the bank's announced management change may weigh on the stock unless the communication from incoming CEO suggests a sharp increase in payouts.
- Apart from increased dividends and buybacks, another potential use of capital could be via M&A; else, we see ROEs coming off in next 3Y on lower NIM. If a transaction were to be announced, share price moves would be a function of pricing and fit.
- We expect 22bps/12bps NIM compression in FY25/26E, following a sharp 23bps decline over the last 4 quarters, as well as declines in SORA and HIBOR. OCBC has 37% of loans in SGD and 11% in HKD.
- The bank has expanded inorganically over the last 10-15 years, with Wing Hang and Bank of Ningbo being notable transactions. There appears to be a commitment to deepen this presence, with capabilities being broadened in the GBA and HK markets, among others. This could lead to near-term risks if the growth in Greater China is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.

Valuation

Our Jun-26 PT of S\$18 is based on a fair P/B of 1.21x, assuming a normalized RoE of 12.4%, a risk-free rate of 4.7%, a cost of capital of 10.4% and a growth rate of 1.0%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which can drive faster growth at the group.

Downside risks include weaker than expected NIM, market share losses in wealth management, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
01-Nov-22	N	12.13	13
06-Jan-23	OW	12.44	14
09-Mar-23	OW	12.55	13.5
30-Mar-23	UW	12.53	11.5
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
17-Aug-22	OW	29.37	33
23-Nov-22	N	32.34	34
09-Mar-23	N	30.64	31
30-Mar-23	UW	30.54	27
05-Oct-23	UW	30.20	28
09-Dec-23	UW	28.73	27.5
13-Mar-24	N	30.46	30
03-Jul-24	OW	37.10	41
06-Oct-24	OW	38.04	42
10-Nov-24	OW	42.40	50
11-Feb-25	OW	45.38	51
23-Mar-25	OW	45.31	49
21-May-25	N	44.38	47
13-Jul-25	N	45.99	48

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
02-Aug-22	OW	27.89	34
30-Mar-23	N	29.95	28.5
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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